



The fleur-de-lis was the emblem of the king of France. Most of the leaders of the First Crusade were Frankish.

The imperial eagle was the emblem of the Holy Roman Empire. German emperors led armies to the east in 1145, 1189, and 1228.

in 1098. A year later the crusaders arrived at Jerusalem. After a lengthy siege, the city fell. The crusaders slaughtered all Muslims and Jews in the city—a bloody climax that set the tone for much that was to follow.

Outremer

The crusaders now held a thin strip of coast in Palestine along which they established various crusader states, including the Kingdom of Jerusalem, the Counties of Edessa and Tripoli, and the

Principality of Antioch. These territories were known collectively as *Outremer*, meaning “the land overseas.”

In time, the crusaders built huge fortresses to defend these outposts, such as Crac de Chevalier. Despite this, their grip on the territories was never strong; they were often threatened by resurgent Muslim forces, and relied on further crusades from Europe to come to their aid.

The period also saw the formation of the military orders, the Templars and the



Templar seal

United in the service of Christ, two knights are shown sharing one horse.

SULTAN OF EGYPT AND SYRIA (1138–93)

SALADIN

Founder of the Ayyubid dynasty and unifier of Muslim states in the Middle East against the crusaders, Saladin was also renowned throughout Christendom as an honorable and chivalrous leader. Contemporary accounts abound with stories of his gallantry.

In 1187 Saladin annihilated the crusader armies at Hattin. When Jerusalem fell three months later, he allowed neither massacre nor looting. Although he failed to expel the crusaders from the Holy Land, and was defeated at Arsuf in 1191 by Richard I of England, Saladin paved the way for the later elimination of the Crusader states.



1,000 The number of beds in the pilgrim hospital run by the Order of St. John of Jerusalem, also known as the Knights Hospitallers. During the 12th century the knights adopted a military role.

Hospitallers, whose members took vows of poverty and chastity to dedicate their lives to the defense of the Holy Land. These warrior monks were the closest thing the crusaders had to a standing, professional army. They often pursued their own interests at the expense of their fellow Christians, but they built a fearsome reputation—after the battle of Hattin in 1187, the Sultan Saladin (see above) allowed the ransom of all prisoners except for the Templars and Hospitallers, whom he had executed.

The later crusades

Never again would the Muslim states of the Holy Land be so unprepared as they had been at the time of the First Crusade. A second crusade was organized in 1145, following the fall of Edessa, but failed to retake the city from Nureddin, a Muslim ruler who had united much of Syria against the crusaders. By the 1180s, most of the Muslim inhabitants of Syria and Palestine were united under Nureddin's successor, the sultan Saladin. In 1187 Saladin destroyed the armies of the crusader kingdoms at Hattin and seized Jerusalem, gallantly sparing the lives of the Christians in the city.

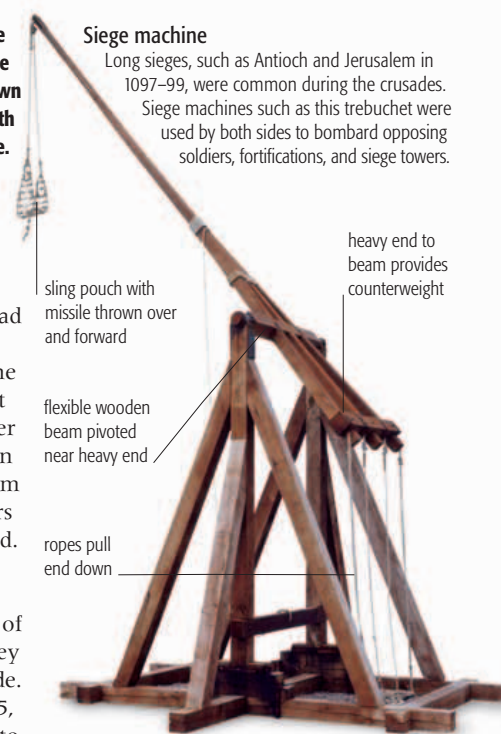
Subsequent crusades to Egypt and the Holy Land enjoyed some success but many setbacks. The Fourth Crusade, in 1198, never made it to the Holy Land, instead seizing the Christian city of Constantinople from Byzantium (see pp.198–99). Major expeditions from Europe were sporadic, and the fortunes of the crusader states altered with the balance of power in the east.

After the fall of the port of Acre in 1291 defense of the mainland territories became impossible. The remaining Christian cities were abandoned and the crusaders expelled from the Holy Land.

Siege machine

Long sieges, such as Antioch and Jerusalem in 1097–99, were common during the crusades.

Siege machines such as this trebuchet were used by both sides to bombard opposing soldiers, fortifications, and siege towers.



AFTER

Greed and political expediency gradually came to undermine the ideals of the early crusades.

CRUSADES IN EUROPE

The crusading ideal of war against the enemies of Christianity in the Holy Land soon lost focus. As early as 1193 Pope **Celestine III** proclaimed a crusade against **pagans in northern Europe**. In 1209, **Innocent III** announced a crusade against **heretics** within France—the **Albigensian Crusade**. By the 1230s popes were using crusades as a political weapon against rivals.

END OF THE KNIGHTS TEMPLAR

Military orders such as the Templars grew immensely **rich and powerful**, attracting much criticism. In 1307, intending to seize their assets, **Philip IV** of France charged the Templars with **heresy**. Pope **Clement V** disbanded the order.